

GOTLAND

A Traveller's Handbook, 1954 edition -- excerpt: Visby and Roma

In and around Visby

Visby, the ancient Hanseatic town, is best explored on foot. Distances and times below are given from the steamer harbor, where most travellers begin and end their visit to the town.

Sight	Distance/time from harbor	Opening hours	Fee
Ring Wall (Ringmuren)	5 min walk to nearest gate; full circuit approx. 1.5 h on foot	Always open	None
S:ta Maria Cathedral	5 min walk	09:00 - 17:00	None
Gotlands Fornsal (county museum)	10 min walk	11:00 - 16:00	1 kr
Botanical Garden (Tradgardsforeningen)	15 min walk	Open until dusk (approx. 20:00 in September)	None

Roma

The village of Roma, home to the sugar mill and the railway junction, also holds the ruins of Roma Abbey (Roma Kloster), founded by Cistercian monks in the 12th century.

Sight	Distance/time from Roma railway station	Opening hours	Fee
Roma Abbey ruins (Roma Kloster)	10 min walk	Always open	None

Further afield

The island of Faro, to the north, with its striking limestone raukar formations, is a popular excursion, but the return journey by road and the small free ferry crossing takes most of a day. It is not feasible to visit Faro in half a day from Visby or Roma; travellers with only an afternoon free should not attempt this trip.

Bungemuseet, an open-air museum of Gotlandic farm life, lies in the north of the island and likewise requires a full day's excursion from Visby.

Practical notes

The walk from Visby harbor to the railway station takes approximately 10 minutes.

Museums and the cathedral request that visitors arrive at least 15 minutes before closing time.